

YEAR 9 (AFTER PREP) · THEME 7 · LIFE IN NATURE & GLOBAL PROBLEMS

Grammar

B2.1

Defining Relative Clauses (who / which / that) · Non-Defining Relative Clauses (who / which, with commas) · Omitting the Relative Pronoun (Object Relative Clauses) · Relative Clauses with 'whose' (Possession)

Hazırlık
Sonrası 9.
Sınıf

Name – Surname

Class

No

Date

Aim Discover the grammar from examples, explain the rule in your own words and use it correctly in context.

Defining Relative Clauses (who / which / that)

1 · NOTICE

- Scientists **who study earthquakes** can now predict some tremors more accurately.
- The flood **that destroyed the village** changed the way the government plans for disasters.
- This is the kind of technology **which helps doctors diagnose diseases faster**.
- People **who live near the coast** are usually the most vulnerable to storms.

In each sentence, does the relative clause give essential information about the noun before it, or could we remove it without losing important meaning? Which word introduces each clause?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Look at the Notice sentences again. Complete the rule with the words in the box.

who which that no commas

- We use _____ or _____ for people.
- We use _____ or _____ for things.
- Defining relative clauses give essential information, so we use _____ around them.

B Build sentences

Combine the two sentences into one, using who/which/that.

e.g. Scientists study earthquakes. They can now predict some tremors.

Scientists who study earthquakes can now predict some tremors.

- The disaster destroyed hundreds of homes. It happened last spring.

- An algorithm analyses weather data. It can warn people hours before a storm.

3. The volunteers helped flood victims. They worked day and night.
4. This is the app. It predicts wildfires using AI.
5. ? / the scientists / develop early warning systems / do you know them

C Your turn

Write four sentences about natural disasters or technology, each with a defining relative clause (who/which/that).

Scientists who...

The disaster that...

A system which...

People who...

RULE

A defining relative clause gives essential information about the noun in the main clause; without it, the sentence's meaning would be incomplete or unclear. Use who/that for people and which/that for things. No commas are used with defining relative clauses.

TR Defining (tanımlayıcı) relative clause, ana cümledeki isim hakkında zorunlu/temel bilgi verir; bu bilgi olmadan cümlelerin anlamı eksik veya belirsiz kalır. İnsanlar için who/that, nesneler için which/that kullanılır. Bu tür cümlelerde virgül KULLANILMAZ.

When?

We use defining relative clauses when we need to make clear exactly which person or thing we are talking about — for example, identifying one specific disaster among many.

TR Hangi kişi ya da nesneden bahsettiğimizi netleştirmek istediğimizde defining relative clause kullanırız — örneğin birçok deprem arasından belirli birini tanımlarken.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
Scientists who study earthquakes work at the university.	People who don't prepare for disasters are more at risk.	Is this the technology that helps predict wildfires?	Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.
The app that predicts floods is free.	This isn't the system which we tested last year.	Do you know the scientist who developed this algorithm?	Yes, I do. / No, I don't.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
The scientist, who developed the app, works at our university.	The scientist who developed the app works at our university.	No commas are used with a defining relative clause, because the information is essential. TR Zorunlu bilgi veren defining clause'da virgül kullanılmaz.
This is the village which it was destroyed by the flood.	This is the village which was destroyed by the flood.	Don't repeat the subject pronoun (it/he/she) inside the relative clause. TR Relative clause içinde özne olan 'it' gibi bir zamir tekrar kullanılmaz.

1 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- The volunteers _____ arrived first saved many lives.
☐ a who ☐ b which ☐ c whom
- This is the drone _____ films the flooded areas from above.
☐ a who ☐ b which ☐ c whose
- People _____ live in coastal areas face a higher flood risk.
☐ a which ☐ b who ☐ c whom

2 Complete with who / which / that.

3 × 1 pts

- The scientist _____ built the early warning app won an award.
- This is the technology _____ helps doctors predict disease outbreaks.
- The town _____ was hit by the earthquake is slowly rebuilding.

3 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

- The engineer, who designed the system, is famous. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

- This is the app that predicts wildfires. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

4 Complete with that/which.

2 × 1 pts

Challenge

- A: Have you seen the video _____ shows the flood damage?
- B: Yes! It's the one _____ went viral last week.

5 Reorder the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. very accurate app the floods predicts is which .

Non-Defining Relative Clauses (who / which, with commas)**1 · NOTICE**

- The 2023 earthquake, **which affected millions of people**, changed disaster policy across the region.
- Dr. Aylin Kaya, **who leads the early warning project**, spoke at the conference yesterday.
- Wildfires, **which are becoming more frequent because of climate change**, threaten entire ecosystems.
- My uncle, **who works for a relief organisation**, has helped after three major floods.

Is the information in the relative clause essential, or is it extra/additional information? What punctuation marks it off from the rest of the sentence? Could you use 'that' instead of 'who/which' here?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

extra/additional commas cannot use 'that'

- Non-defining relative clauses give _____ information — the sentence still makes sense without them.
- We separate a non-defining clause from the rest of the sentence with _____.
- In non-defining clauses, we _____.

B Build sentences

Rewrite the sentence, adding commas to punctuate the non-defining relative clause correctly.

- e.g. The Kobe earthquake which happened in 1995 killed thousands of people.

The Kobe earthquake, which happened in 1995, killed thousands of people.

- Professor Demir who studies climate change gave a lecture on droughts.
- The Amazon rainforest which produces a huge amount of oxygen is losing trees every year.
- This app which was created by students won a technology prize.

4. My cousin who volunteers for disaster relief is travelling to the flood zone.

C Your turn

Write three sentences about people or places you know, adding extra (non-defining) information with who/which and commas.

My..., who...,, which..., is/was...

RULE

A non-defining relative clause adds extra information about the noun; the sentence still makes complete sense without it. Commas are used before and after the clause, and 'that' is NOT used in non-defining clauses.

TR Non-defining (tanımlayıcı olmayan) relative clause, ana cümledeki isim hakkında EK/fazladan bilgi verir; bu bilgi çıkarılsa bile cümle hâlâ anlamlıdır. Cümlelerin başında ve sonunda VİRGÜL kullanılır ve bu tür cümlelerde 'that' KULLANILMAZ.

When?

We use non-defining relative clauses to add an interesting or extra detail about a noun whose identity is already clear (proper names, unique people or places).

TR Zaten kim/ne olduğu belli olan bir isim (özel isimler, tek olan yer/kişiler) hakkında ilginç ya da ek bir detay eklemek istediğimizde non-defining relative clause kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
The 2023 earthquake, which affected millions, changed disaster policy. Dr. Kaya, who leads the project, spoke yesterday.	The report, which wasn't published until March, surprised experts. My uncle, who doesn't usually travel far, went to help.	Have you read about the Amazon, which is losing trees every year? Do you know Dr. Kaya, who developed the warning system?	Yes, I have. / No, I haven't. Yes, I do. / No, I don't.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
The Amazon rainforest, that produces oxygen, is shrinking.	The Amazon rainforest, which produces oxygen, is shrinking.	'That' cannot be used in non-defining relative clauses — use who or which. TR Non-defining clause'larda 'that' kullanılmaz, sadece who/which kullanılır.
My uncle who works for a relief organisation is here.	My uncle, who works for a relief organisation, is here.	Because 'my uncle' already identifies one specific person, the extra information needs commas. TR Tek/belli bir kişi (my uncle) hakkında ek bilgi verildiği için virgül gerekir.

6 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

1. Mount Everest, _____ is the world's highest mountain, attracts thousands of climbers.
 (a) that (b) which (c) who
2. My sister, _____ works as a nurse, helped after the earthquake.
 (a) who (b) that (c) which
3. Which sentence is punctuated correctly?
 (a) The scientist, who developed the app won an award.
 (b) The scientist who developed the app, won an award.
 (c) The scientist, who developed the app, won an award.

7 Complete with who / which.

2 × 1 pts

1. The flood, _____ destroyed hundreds of homes, happened in April.
2. Professor Aydın, _____ leads our research team, is studying drought patterns.

8 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

1. The report that we published last year, was very detailed. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

2. Türkiye, which lies on two continents, experiences frequent earthquakes. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

9 Complete with who/which.

2 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. A: Have you met Dr. Kaya, _____ leads the AI disaster project?
2. B: Not yet, but I read her report, _____ was published last month.

Omitting the Relative Pronoun (Object Relative Clauses)**1 · NOTICE**

- The report (**that**) scientists published last year warned about rising sea levels.
- The app (**which**) my brother uses tracks earthquake activity in real time.
- I still remember the storm (**that**) we experienced two years ago.
- The volunteers (**who**) the organisation trained worked in the flood zone.

In each sentence, is the person/thing in the relative clause the subject or the object of the verb inside that clause? Which word could be left out without changing the meaning?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

object

subject

cannot be omitted

1. When the relative pronoun is the _____ of the relative clause verb (the clause already has its own subject), it can often be omitted.
2. When the relative pronoun is the _____ of the relative clause verb, it must stay.
3. A relative pronoun that is the subject of the clause _____.

B Build sentences

Say whether the relative pronoun can be omitted. Rewrite the sentence without it, or write 'cannot omit' and explain why.

e.g. The scientist that we interviewed studies volcanoes. (object)

The scientist we interviewed studies volcanoes.

1. The data that the sensors collect helps predict earthquakes. (object)

2. The engineers who designed the app are from Izmir. (subject)

3. The house that the storm destroyed was empty. (object)

4. The system which predicts floods was built by students. (subject)

C Your turn

Write two sentences with an object relative clause where you can omit the pronoun, and one sentence with a subject relative clause where you cannot.

The ... I ...

The ... that/which ... (subject) ...

RULE

The relative pronoun (that/which/who) can usually be omitted when it is the **OBJECT** of the relative clause (the clause has its own subject). It cannot be omitted when it is the **SUBJECT** of the clause. This rule only applies to defining relative clauses.

TR Relative pronoun (that/which/who), relative clause içinde NESNE görevindeyse (clause'un kendi öznesi varsa) genellikle atlanabilir. Ancak relative pronoun clause'un ÖZNESİ ise atlanamaz. Bu kural sadece defining relative clause'lar için geçerlidir.

When?

We often omit the object relative pronoun in speech and everyday writing to make sentences sound more natural and less formal.

TR Konuşma dilinde ve günlük yazıda cümleyi daha akıcı hale getirmek için nesne konumundaki relative pronoun'u atlarız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
The report (that) we read was alarming.	The data (that) we collected wasn't complete.	Is this the app (that) you downloaded?	Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.
The scientist who studies volcanoes gave a talk.	The system which predicts floods doesn't always work.	Is this the scientist who developed the app?	Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
The scientist studies volcanoes gave a talk.	The scientist who studies volcanoes gave a talk.	A subject relative pronoun cannot be omitted. TR Relative pronoun clause'un öznesiyse atlanamaz.
This is the report which, I read yesterday.	This is the report (which) I read yesterday.	The object relative pronoun can be dropped, but if it stays, no comma is used in a defining clause. TR Nesne relative pronoun atlanabilir ama kalırsa virgül kullanılmaz (defining clause).

10 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- Which sentence CANNOT drop the relative pronoun?

(a) The house (that) the flood destroyed is empty. (b) The scientist who studies volcanoes gave a talk.

(c) The report (that) we published was long.
- The app _____ my brother downloaded tracks earthquakes. (most natural, informal)

(a) that (b) — (no word needed) (c) whom
- The volunteers _____ arrived first started the rescue.

(a) (nothing) (b) who (c) —

11 Complete with the correct form.

2 × 1 pts

- The data the sensors _____ (collect) helps scientists predict storms.
- This is the algorithm _____ engineers designed for flood prediction. (formal style, add the pronoun)

12 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

1. The engineers designed the app won an award. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

2. The report we read yesterday was alarming. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

13 Complete with that/which.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. A: Is this the data _____ the AI system uses? (formal)

14 Reorder the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. the was flood the destroyed empty house .

Relative Clauses with 'whose' (Possession)

1 · NOTICE

- The scientist **whose research predicted the earthquake** received an award.
- We interviewed a family **whose house was destroyed by the flood**.
- This is the village **whose water supply was affected by the drought**.
- The company **whose app warns people about wildfires** is expanding across the country.

What does 'whose' show — possession, location or time? Can 'whose' be used only for people, or for people and things too?

2 · DISCOVER — A · COMPLETE THE RULE

Complete the rule with the words in the box.

possession people and things noun

- 'Whose' shows _____ — something belongs to someone or something.
- 'Whose' can be used for _____, unlike who/which.
- After 'whose' we always need a _____ (whose + noun).

B Build sentences

Combine the sentences using whose.

e.g. We interviewed a family. Their house was destroyed.

We interviewed a family whose house was destroyed.

1. The scientist won an award. Her research predicted the earthquake.
2. The village lost its water supply. Its wells dried up during the drought.
3. The company is expanding. Its app warns people about wildfires.
4. I spoke to a boy. His school was flooded last year.

C Your turn

Write three sentences with 'whose', describing people, places or organisations connected to natural disasters or technology.

The scientist whose... A family whose... The city whose...

RULE

'Whose' is a possessive relative pronoun used to show that something belongs to a person or thing already mentioned. It can be used for people AND things/places, and it is always followed by a noun (whose + noun).

TR 'Whose', bir kişi ya da şeye ait olan bir başka isim hakkında bilgi vermek için kullanılan iyelik bildiren relative pronoun'dur. Hem insanlar hem de nesneler/yerler için kullanılabilir ve kendisinden sonra mutlaka bir isim gelir (whose + isim).

When?

We use 'whose' to introduce a feature that belongs to a person or place — their house, family, system, and so on.

TR Bir kişinin ya da yerin sahip olduğu bir özelliği (evi, ailesi, sistemi vb.) tanıtırken 'whose' kullanırız.

POSITIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION	SHORT ANSWERS
The scientist whose research predicted the earthquake won an award.	The family whose house wasn't damaged still helped their neighbours.	Is this the scientist whose research predicted the earthquake?	Yes, it is. / No, it isn't.
The village whose wells dried up needs help.	This isn't the company whose app failed.	Do you know the family whose house was destroyed?	Yes, I do. / No, I don't.

X WRONG	✓ RIGHT	WHY?
The scientist who's research predicted the earthquake won an award.	The scientist whose research predicted the earthquake won an award.	Don't confuse 'whose' (possessive) with 'who's' (short for 'who is/has'). TR 'Whose' (iyelik) ile 'who's' (who is/has kısaltması) karıştırılmamalı.
The village whose it lost its water supply needs help.	The village whose water supply was lost needs help.	Don't add another possessive pronoun (it/its) — 'whose' already shows possession. TR 'Whose' zaten iyelik anlamı verdiği için ayrıca 'it/its' kullanılmaz.

15 Choose the correct option.

3 × 1 pts

- The engineer _____ app predicts wildfires works at our university.
☐ a who ☐ b whose ☐ c which
- This is the town _____ water supply was affected by the drought.
☐ a who ☐ b whose ☐ c which
- Choose the correct sentence.
☐ a The scientist who's research is famous spoke today.
☐ b The scientist whose research is famous spoke today.
☐ c The scientist which research is famous spoke today.

16 Complete with whose.

2 × 1 pts

- We met a family _____ house had been flooded twice.
- The company _____ app won the innovation prize is based in Ankara.

17 Judge the sentence.

2 × 1 pts

- The scientist who's research predicted the flood is famous now. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect
- This is the village whose wells dried up during the drought. ☐ Correct ☐ Incorrect

18 Complete with whose.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

- A: Do you know the family _____ house was rebuilt after the earthquake?

19 Reorder the sentence.

1 × 1 pts

Challenge

1. predicted award whose the an earthquake research scientist the won .
-